

using *red-teaming*, a methodology wherein ethical hackers will work with the tech companies to pre-emptively identify and sort out vulnerabilities. The US government also announced the launch of its own AI Safety Institute, under the aegis of its National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST). During the recent summit, Sunak announced that UK's AI Safety Institute will collaborate with AI Safety Institute of the US and with the government of Singapore, another notable AI stronghold.

At the end of October 2023, the G7 revealed the International Guiding Principles on artificial intelligence and a voluntary Code of Conduct for AI developers. Part of the *Hiroshima AI Process* that began in May 2023, these guiding documents will provide actionable guidelines for governments and organisations involved in AI development.

In October, the United Nations Secretary-General António Guterres announced the creation of a new AI Advisory Body, to build a global scientific consensus on risks and challenges, strengthen international cooperation on AI governance, and enable nations to safely harness the transformative potential of AI.

India takes a balanced view of AI

At the AI Safety Summit, India's Minister of State for Electronics and IT, Rajeev Chandrasekhar, proposed that AI should not be demonised to the extent that it is regulated out of existence. It is a kinetic enabler of India's digital economy and presents a big opportunity for us. At the same time, he acknowledged that proper regulations must be in place to avoid misuse of the technology. He opined that in the past decade, countries across the world, including ours, inadvertently let regulations fall behind innovation, and are now having to contend with the menace of toxicity and misinformation across social media platforms. As AI has the potential to amplify toxicity and



Union Minister Rajeev Chandrasekhar at the AI Safety Summit held in UK in November 2023
(Source: Press Information Bureau)

weaponisation to the next level, he said that countries should work together to be ahead, or at least at par with innovation, when it comes to regulating AI.

“The broad areas, which we need to deliberate upon, are workforce disruption by AI, its impact on privacy of individuals, weaponisation and criminalisation of AI, and what must be done to have a global, coordinated action against banned actors, who may create unsafe and untrusted models, that may be available on the dark web and can be misused,” he said to the media.

Speaking to the media after the summit, he said that these issues will be carried forward and discussed at the Global Partner for AI (GPAI) Summit that India is chairing in December 2023. He also said that India will strive to create an early regulatory framework for AI, within the next five or six months. Pointing out that innovation is happening at hyper speed, he stressed that countries must address this issue urgently without spending two or three years in intellectual debate.

AI—To be or not to be

Outside Bletchley Park, a group of protestors, under the banner of ‘Pause AI,’ were seeking a temporary pause on the training of AI systems more powerful than OpenAI's GPT-4. Speaking to the

press, Mustafa Suleyman, the cofounder of Google DeepMind and now the CEO of startup Inflection AI, said that, while he disagreed with those seeking a pause on next generation AI systems, the industry may have to consider that course of action sometime soon. “I do not think there is any evidence today that frontier models of the size of GPT-4 present any significant catastrophic harms, let alone any existential harms. It is objectively clear that there is incredible value to people in the world. But it is a very sensible question to ask, as we create models which are 10 times larger, 100 times larger, 1000 times larger, which is going to happen over the next three or four years,” he said.

Industry attendees had also remarked in social media about the evergreen debate of open source versus closed-source approaches to AI research. While some felt that it was too risky to freely distribute the source code of powerful AI models, the open source community argued that open sourcing the models will help speed up and intensify safety research rather than the code being within the realms of profit-driven companies.

It is interesting to note that the event happened at Bletchley Park, a stately mansion near London, which was once the secret home of the ‘code-breakers,’